RESTRAINT SYSTEM—AIR BAG DEPLOYMENT STRATEGY WITH ADVANCED RESTRAINT SYSTEM	Article No. 02-17-5

FORD: 2001-2002 CROWN VICTORIA
2002 TAURUS
2001-2002 WINDSTAR

LINCOLN: 2001 TOWN CAR

MERCURY: 2001-2002 GRAND MARQUIS
2002 SABLE

ISSUE

Questions about the operation of the air bag system may occur with normal air bag/pre-tensioner deployment strategies. Example: the passenger air bag may deploy when the driver air bag does not deploy.

ACTION

This TSB is provided as a resource to better understand the system operation and address customer inquiries about the operation of the Advanced Restraint System equipped in these vehicles. Refer to the following Service Information for details.

SERVICE INFORMATION

Advanced Restraint System Overview:

2001-2002 Crown Victoria/Grand Marquis, Windstar, 2001 Town Car and 2002 Taurus/Sable are equipped with the Advanced Restraint System that manages deployment of the driver air bag, passenger airbag, driver pre-tensioner, and passenger pre-tensioner separately. The Advanced Restraint System has the ability to shift the air bag deployment threshold based on whether the seat belt is buckled or not. In some circumstances only one air bag may deploy.

Normal System Operation Examples:

If the driver seat belt is buckled, and the electronic crash sensors predict the crash will be approximately as severe as the threshold where earlier models deployed the air bag, it will deploy the seat belt pre-tensioner but NOT the air bag. The sensors must predict a more serious collision before the driver air bag will deploy.

However, if the passenger seat belt is unbuckled, the passenger air bag will deploy at approximately the same threshold where earlier models deployed the air bag, and about the same threshold as where the driver seat belt pre-tensioner deploys.

The most common example that causes questions: A belted driver and no passenger in the vehicle. A driver experiences a collision between the two thresholds mentioned in the prior example, and the driver notes that only the passenger air bag deployed. Since the driver cannot visibly see if the driver or passenger seat belt pre-tensioners deployed, the customer becomes concerned that the driver's air bag did not deploy. This is an example of a properly operating Advanced Restraint System.

OTHER APPLICABLE ARTICLES: NONE
WARRANTY STATUS: INFORMATION ONLY
OASIS CODES: 104000, 190000, 206000, 290000

NOTE: The information in Technical Service Bulletins is intended for use by trained, professional technicians with the knowledge, tools, and equipment to do the job properly and safely. It informs these technicians of conditions that may occur on some vehicles, or provides information that could assist in proper vehicle service. The procedures should not be performed by "do-it-yourselfers". Do not assume that a condition described affects your car or truck. Contact a Ford, Lincoln, or Mercury dealership to determine whether the Bulletin applies to your vehicle.
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